

3 days Axum & Gherlata Churches

This three-day tour explores the ancient wonders of Axum and the breathtaking rock-hewn churches of Gheralta. Discover Axum's iconic obelisks, the legendary St. Mary of Zion Church, and the ruins of the Queen of Sheba's Palace. Travel to Gheralta for an adventurous climb to Abuna Yemata Guh, offering stunning views and centuries-old frescoes. Visit more hidden rock churches before concluding the trip with a scenic drive to Mekele for your flight back to Addis Ababa.

Day 1: Arrival in Axum – Exploring the Ancient Kingdom

Take a morning flight from Addis Ababa to Axum, the heart of Ethiopia's ancient civilization. Upon arrival, check into your hotel and start exploring the Axum Obelisks, towering monuments from the Aksumite Empire. Visit the St. Mary of Zion Church, believed to house the Ark of the Covenant, and continue to the Queen of Sheba's Palace, where legends say she once ruled. In the afternoon, visit the Tombs of King Kaleb and Gebre Meskel, then explore the Axum Museum for deeper insights into this once-powerful empire. Enjoy dinner at a local restaurant and rest for the night.

Day 2: Drive to Gheralta – Exploring the Rock-Hewn Churches

After breakfast, embark on a scenic drive to Gheralta, a region famous for its breathtaking rock formations and ancient rock-hewn churches. Upon arrival, check into your lodge and prepare for an adventure to Abuna Yemata Guh, one of Ethiopia's most awe-inspiring churches, perched high on a cliffside. The hike to the church is challenging but rewarding, offering panoramic views of the Gheralta mountains. In the afternoon, visit Maryam Korkor and Daniel Korkor, two other stunning rock churches known for their frescoes and remote locations. Spend the evening relaxing at your lodge, enjoying the sunset over the rugged landscape.

Day 3: More of Gheralta – Drive to Mekele – Flight to Addis Ababa

Start your morning with a visit to another hidden gem of Gheralta, such as Debre Tsion or Yohannes Maequddi, known for their intricate carvings and spiritual ambiance. Afterward, begin your journey toward Mekele, enjoying the scenic drive through the Tigray highlands. Upon arrival in Mekele, have lunch before transferring to the airport for your flight back to Addis Ababa, concluding your Axum and Gheralta adventure.